

Table Chart

Cambridge IELTS 10 Test 2

WRITING TASK 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task,

The tables below give information about sales Of Fairtrade•-labelled coffee and bananas in 1999 and 2004 in five European countries.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Write at least 150 words,

Sales of Fairtrade-labelled coffee and bananas (1999 & 2004)

Coffee	1999 (millions of euros)	2004 (millions of euros)
UK	1.5	20
Switzerland	3	6
Denmark	1.8	2
Belgium	1	1.7
Sweden	0.8	1

Bananas	1999 (millions of euros)	2004 (millions of euros)
Switzerland	1.5	20
UK	3	6
Belgium	1.8	2
Sweden	1	1.7
Denmark	0.8	1

*Fairtrade: a category of products for which farmers from developing countries have been paid an officially agreed fair price.

Sample Answer:

The tables compare the sales of Fairtrade-labelled coffee and bananas in five European countries between 1999 and 2004, expressed in millions of euros.

In 1999, coffee sales were relatively low in all five countries, with the UK leading at 1.5 million euros, followed by Switzerland and Denmark at 3 million and 1.8 million euros respectively. Belgium and Sweden had the lowest sales, at 1 million and 0.8 million euros. By 2004, all countries saw significant increases in sales. The UK experienced the most dramatic rise, from 1.5 million euros to 20 million euros. Switzerland also saw a substantial increase, doubling its sales from 3 million euros to 6 million euros. Denmark, Belgium, and Sweden also showed growth, though less pronounced, with sales reaching 2 million, 1.7 million, and 1 million euros respectively.

Banana sales in 1999 were highest in Switzerland at 15 million euros, significantly more than in other countries. The UK and Sweden followed, with sales of 1 million and 1.8 million euros respectively.

Belgium and Denmark had the lowest sales figures for bananas, at 0.6 million and 2 million euros. By 2004, banana sales had increased dramatically in all countries except Denmark, which saw a slight decrease to 0.9 million euros. Switzerland's sales nearly tripled to 4.7 million euros, while the UK's sales increased more than fivefold to 5.5 million euros. Belgium also saw a notable rise to 4 million euros.

Overall, the period from 1999 to 2004 saw significant growth in the sales of Fairtrade-labelled coffee and bananas across these European countries. The most remarkable growth was observed in the UK for coffee and Switzerland for bananas, indicating a substantial increase in consumer demand for Fairtrade products in these nations.

Grammar and Vocabulary Activities:

Grammar Activity:

1. **Comparatives and Superlatives:** Practice constructing sentences using comparative and superlative forms to describe changes in sales figures. For example, "Switzerland had the highest sales of bananas in 1999."
2. **Past Simple and Past Perfect:** Use the past simple to describe what happened in 1999 and 2004, and the past perfect to discuss changes over the period. Example: "By 2004, the UK had increased its coffee sales significantly."

Vocabulary Activity:

- **Synonyms for Increase and Decrease:** Identify synonyms to replace 'increase' and 'decrease' to enhance descriptive vocabulary. Examples include "soar," "climb," "drop," and "decline."
- **Business and Sales Terms:** Discuss and apply vocabulary related to sales and business, such as "revenue," "market growth," "consumer demand," and "sales figures."
- **Describing Graphs and Tables:** Use phrases suited for describing data in tables and charts, such as "doubled its sales," "experienced growth," and "saw a rise."